

DISSERTATION WRITING WORKSPACE

Outline + Organized Notes | Section 3: Emerging Adulthood

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Outline + Organized Notes | Real-Time Reference

****CURRENT LOCATION:**** Section 3 — Emerging Adulthood Population

CHAPTER 1: LITERATURE REVIEW

1.1 Introduction

What you need here:

- Hook on correctional rehabilitation
- Recidivism stats
- Intro to emerging adults (18-26)
- Brief mention of developmental stages
- Problem statement at the end

YOUR NOTES TO PULL:

""Each day in the US, 6,730,900 residents or about 1 in 37 adults among us are under some form of correctional supervision. More than 2.1 million Americans are guarded behind jail or prison bars and nearly 4.7 million are watched on probation or parole" (Cullen)

""On any given day in the US, over 7 million offenders are under some form of correctional supervision" (Lipsey & Cullen)

""85% of all adolescents who are placed into residential tx will be reincarcerated within 5 years" (Mowen et al.)

""Approximately 80% of violent juvenile offenders in some studies recidivate upon release from incarceration, while only 3.6% of juvenile offenders receive some form of substance use/abuse treatment"

PROBLEM STATEMENT (end of section):

"There is limited availability of evidence-based developmentally tailored rehabilitation programs that promote desistance among young adult offenders in correctional settings.

1.2 Contextual Background

What you need:

- US correctional trends
- Incarceration rates
- Reoffending stats for young adults
- Need for age-responsive programming

YOUR NOTES:

""Juvenile incarceration costs approximately \$5.7 billion each year and alcohol and drug tax curricula for youth offenders costing approximately \$139 million each year"

""33% of youth in the study reoffended within 1 year" (Robertson et al.)

""Recidivism rates were 22% within 6 months, 34.1% within 12 months, 51.2% within 24 months, and 61% within 36 months"

1.3 Relevance to Forensic Psychology

What you need:

- Link between psych interventions (CBT, schema therapy) and behavioral change

YOUR NOTES:

""Correctional rehabilitation can be justified on moral grounds as a humane alternative to efforts to inflict pain on the convicted and for the investment it makes in offenders' lives"

""The relationship b/w mental illness and offending varies by disorder, with externalizing disorders being directly linked to offending"

1.4 Purpose of Program Development

What you need:

- Aim: foster desistance through targeted psychological intervention
- Organization preview

YOUR NOTES:

""a planned correctional intervention that targets for change internal and/or social criminogenic factors with the goal of reducing recidivism and, where possible of improving other aspects of an offenders life"

CHAPTER 2: THEORETICAL FOUNDATIONS

2.1 Overview of Theoretical Frameworks

What you need:

- Importance of theory-driven programming

YOUR NOTES:

""A good theory will also be consistent with other strong theories in the broader domain of the biological, human, and social sciences"

""Theories should organize empirical knowledge in a rational and attractive manner and also assist in the search for new empirical understanding"

2.2 Theories of Criminal Behavior

SOCIAL LEARNING THEORY:

""crime is not inherited, biologically determined, or caused by individual pathology, but rather acquired through communication and interaction with others"

""Individuals learn criminal behavior in the same way they learn any other behavior—through exposure, modeling, and reinforcement within social contexts"

GENERAL STRAIN THEORY (Agnew):

""The core notion that cumulative and increased exposure to strains serves as a risk factor for crime and delinquency"

""Agnew identified 3 major sources of strain: (1) The failure to achieve positively valued goals, (2) The removal or threat of removal of positively valued stimuli, (3) The presentation with noxious or negatively valued stimuli"

COGNITIVE BEHAVIORAL THEORY:

""Criminal behavior is learned, maintained, and modified through: Cognitive processes, Reinforcement, Modeling, Social context"

""Behavior (prosocial or antisocial) is under the control of antecedent (before the act) and consequent (after the act) conditions"

2.3 Desistance Theories

MATURATION THEORY:

""Agnew argued that decline from the peak of criminal activity among many adolescents occurs in adulthood because of 2 factors: (1) A reduction in strains, (2) Increased likelihood of coping with strains without resorting to crime"

LIFE-COURSE CRIMINOLOGY:

""Moffitt describes 2 primary groups of offenders: Adolescent limited (AL), which makes up most offenders, and the life course persistent offenders (LCP)""

2.4 Schema Theory (Jeffrey Young)

What you need:

- Schema therapy principles
- Maladaptive schemas in offenders (mistrust/abuse, defectiveness, entitlement)

YOUR NOTES:

""Maladaptive schemas commonly seen in offender populations (e.g., mistrust/abuse, defectiveness, entitlement)""

""The conceptual level system was developed for use with juvenile delinquents and describes 4 stages of cognitive development""

2.5 Integration of Theories

What you need:

- How CBT and schema therapy jointly support desistance
- Theoretical model guiding dissertation

YOUR NOTES:

""How CBT and schema therapy can jointly support desistance""

""Criminal conduct is best explained through a general personality and cognitive social learning framework""

■ SECTION 3: UNDERSTANDING THE POPULATION — EMERGING ADULTS ■

YOU ARE HERE NOW

3.1 Defining the Age Group

What you need:

- Emerging adulthood definition
- Arnett's 5 features
- Why 18-26 is distinct

YOUR NOTES TO USE NOW:

""Emerging adulthood: refers to a finite period of time, approximately b/w 18-25 years old, where youth in certain cultures go through distinct identity exploration/formation not found in any other age groups and in most other cultures""

ARNETT'S 5 FEATURES:

1. **Age of identity exploration:** ""refers to 2 components of identity development being love and work where individuals begin to experiment and experience each respective factor, ultimately forming a key part of their lifelong identity""
2. **Age of instability:** ""refers to the unpredictability often faced during this age range due to frequent changes in employment, romantic relationships, educational status, and even one's place of residence""
3. **Self-focused age of life:** ""refers to where these individuals that are not quite adults are largely removed from many social obligations and informal social controls""
4. **Age of feeling in-between:** ""indicates a time of confusion where individuals cannot identify with being an adult, adolescent, or some other distinct identity""
5. **Age of possibilities:** ""refers to a period where individuals can make substantial changes to their lives and hopefulness for ones future is at an all time high""

3.2 Developmental Psychology of Emerging Adulthood

What you need:

- Cognitive, emotional, social characteristics
- Brain development and impulsivity
- Identity formation and peer influence

YOUR NOTES:

""Adolescence and emerging adulthood are the age periods of peak offending in the general population as well as among individuals with serious mental health conditions"

""Emerging adulthood are the ages 17-25"

""The motivation most often found for various forms of risky behavior that emerging adults engage in is sensation seeking, the need for new and intense sensory experiences, which many emerging adults consider a part of their identity exploration"

""Young adults are: Still developing executive function, Highly sensitive to peers and reinforcement, More responsive to intervention"

""Ppl with SMHC have greater justice system involvement than those without SMHC just like emerging adults"

3.3 Criminogenic Risk Factors Common to Young Adults

What you need:

- Substance dependence
- Unemployment
- Antisocial peers
- Trauma
- Family dysfunction

YOUR NOTES:

Substance Use:

""Most substance use has been identified as beginning during adolescence with some studies suggesting that substance use at the age of 14 or younger places the juvenile in the most vulnerable position to continue using substances throughout their life course"

""It has been estimated that as high as 78.4% of all teens who have contact with the juvenile justice system in some manner either tested positive for drugs, were under the influence"

""Engaging in drug use early in one's lifetime has been referred to as the 'drug use career' since it does not exist solely in ones adolescence, but oftentimes extends throughout ones entire life course"

Unemployment:

""The # of hours worked per week were also a significant predictor of low-level offending, with those who worked more hours having lower levels of offending"

""Vocational outcomes for emerging adults with mental health conditions are poorer than emerging adults without mental health conditions and more mature adults with mental health conditions"

Trauma/ACEs:

""JI young ppl experience an average of 3 ACE prior to their first arrest, necessitating trauma-informed practice"

""ACE can have an additive effect, with each additional event conferring an increased risk for a range of mental disorders, alcohol and other drug misuse, criminal activity, and subsequent recidivism"

""as high as 80% of violent juvenile offenders in some studies recidivate upon release from incarceration, while only 3.6% of juvenile offenders receive some form of substance use/abuse treatment"

3.4 Challenges in Correctional Environments

What you need:

- Institutionalization effects

- Lack of developmental programming
- Resistance to treatment

YOUR NOTES:

""Justice involvement can be a strong impediment to positive development. It is a strong predictor of school dropout, unemployment, low earnings, welfare dependence, and substance abuse problems in young adulthood"

""There are really no established interventions with evidence of efficacy to reduce recidivism among emerging adults with or without SMHC"

""All current approaches to curb recidivism have moderate effects on recidivism, but the efficacy of these approaches specifically with emerging adults is either unknown or less potent"

""Institutionalization effects, lack of developmental programming, resistance to treatment"

CHAPTER 4: DESISTANCE FROM CRIME

4.1 Conceptualizing Desistance

What you need:

- Primary, secondary, tertiary desistance
- Definition debates

YOUR NOTES:

""Also talk about how the field barely agrees on a set in stone definition and how to measure it"

4.2 Factors That Promote Desistance

What you need:

- Cognitive/identity shifts
- Social bonds (marriage, employment)
- Education
- Treatment engagement

YOUR NOTES:

""life circumstances, such as marriage and employment have been shown to influence desistance"

""Specifically, life-course persistent offenders who desist embrace redemption-oriented identities and experience quality relationships"

""Factors that promote desistance: Cognitive/identity shifts, social bonds, employment, education, treatment engagement"

""You wanna focus on their strengths... for example, if an offender has a capacity for empathy, this strength can be used to enable the person to build rewarding pro-social relationships"

4.3 Gender and Age Considerations

What you need:

- How desistance differs across age and sex

YOUR NOTES:

""Females have lower levels of offending"

""Female criminality peaks early in the life course and women offend, at least for the crimes measured in the study, less than men"

""The available research on gender sensitive interventions for girls and young women suggests that effective tx will target the negative cognitions and emotions that result from trauma with the aim of promoting more adaptive social functioning"

4.4 Empirical Studies & Limitations

What you need:

- Key findings
- Gaps in programs for young adults

YOUR NOTES:

""Study results: 41 participants... 21 fully finished the intervention... There was a significant reduction in mental health sx, with the median number falling substantially from 20 sx to b/w 5 and 6" (MST-EA)

""The prolonged adolescent offender engages in crime and deviance because of failure to breach the maturity gap and achieve adult status, as symbolized by reaching the turning points of marriage, stable employment, and completion of higher educations"

CHAPTER 5: CORRECTIONAL PROGRAMMING & REHABILITATION MODELS

5.1 Evolution of Rehabilitation Models

What you need:

- From punitive to rehabilitative paradigms
- Case law support

YOUR NOTES:

""By the mid 1970s, a massive sentencing reform movement was under way to strip discretion from the system, supported by liberals hoping for short prison sentences and conservatives hoping for larger ones"

""Over the next several decades, every state would curtail the discretion of judges and/or parole boards through practices such as determinate sentencing, sentencing truth in sentencing laws"

""public opinion polls are clear in showing that the american public supports offender rehabilitation as a core correctional goal"

5.2 Risk-Need-Responsivity (RNR) Model

Your full RNR notes are in Chapter 2 — pull from there

Additional for this section:

""The Canadian RNR model is now the dominant tx paradigm in North America, and increasingly across the globe"

""Its central premise is that incorrect or maladaptive cognitions lead and help to maintain problematic emotions and conduct"

""Because the underlying criminological component is based on cognitive social learning theory, preferred interventions fall under the category of CBT"

5.3 Good Lives Model (GLM)

What you need:

- Strengths-based alternative
- Critique/limitations

YOUR NOTES:

""Ward, Melzer, and Yates created the Good Lives Model (GLM) in 2007"

""Says that personal well being is attained through the 'human goods' of enjoyable friendships, work that is valued, and sexual satisfaction"

""Opponents of GLM have questioned the lack of empirical evidence, suggesting GLM interventions dilute RNR principles, thereby compromising the efficacy of RNR to reduce recidivism"

""It is argued that the result of diluting RNR simply creates 'happy but dangerous individuals'"

""As of June 2021, it appears given the published evidence the GLM cannot be purported to be an offender rehabilitation framework that is underpinned by evidence based practice that can reduce recidivism risk"

5.4 Evidence-Based Interventions

CBT:

""preferred interventions fall under the category of CBT"

""A number of meta analyses appeared that reached the same conclusion: across all types of correctional interventions, treatment programs were effective in reducing recidivism by about 10%"

DBT: (Add your DBT notes here)

Schema Therapy: (Already covered in 2.4)

Motivational Interviewing:

""Motivations for change is fundamental, and motivational interviewing (MI) has proven to be an innovative and effective approach when working with forensic populations"

""Results from the meta-analysis indicated that MI was significantly more effective in reducing recidivism rates and increasing session attendance than interventions without MI"

5.5 Effectiveness & Limitations

What you need:

- Meta-analyses
- Success rates
- Lack of developmentally appropriate content for EA

YOUR NOTES:

""A number of meta analyses appeared that reached the same conclusion: across all types of correctional interventions, treatment programs were effective in reducing recidivism by about 10%"

""Interventions that are therapeutic and emphasize a human service approach are most likely to achieve substantial reductions in recidivism"

""Lack of individualized and developmentally appropriate content for emerging adults (18-26)"

""There are really no established interventions with evidence of efficacy to reduce recidivism among emerging adults with or without SMHC"

CHAPTER 6: INTEGRATION OF THERAPEUTIC MODALITIES

6.1 Rationale for CBT + Schema Therapy

What you need:

- Why this integration
- Cognitive restructuring importance

YOUR NOTES:

""cognitive restructuring (why this is important with desistance is because this CBT tenet allows for identity change)"

""Schema modification and cognitive transformation — How schema change supports long term desistance"

6.2 Trauma-Informed Care

What you need:

- Trauma prevalence in this population
- Base rates: correctional vs non-clinical
- Incorporating trauma awareness

YOUR NOTES:

""JI young ppl experience an average of 3 ACE prior to their first arrest, necessitating trauma-informed practice"

""SHARE is a trauma enforced care recommendation for justice involved young ppl"

""Trauma: JI young ppl experience an average of 3 ACE prior to their first arrest, necessitating trauma-informed practice"

6.3 Cultural & Contextual Responsivity

What you need:

- Cultural identity
- SES background
- Systemic barriers

YOUR NOTES:

""Many justice involved young ppl come from minority and/or culturally and linguistically diverse communities"

""These members experience an increased risk of mental illness and increased barriers to mental health service utilization/access"

""Justice involvement is more likely and results in harsher legal, social, and health consequences for ppl of color"

CHAPTER 7: PROGRAM DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK

7.1 Evidence-Based Design Principles

What you need:

- Needs assessment
- Target population specificity

YOUR NOTES:

""It is a truism that a treatment that is not delivered cannot have effects. What is not so obvious is how poorly implemented, even in research studies, and how readily that compromises program effects"

7.2 Program Goals & Objectives

What you need:

- Promote desistance
- Improve coping
- Reduce recidivism
- Gap in mental health treatment in corrections

YOUR NOTES:

""The primary goal of MST-EA are to reduce recidivism and support positive functioning in school, work, independent living, and relationships"

""Check what the gap in the literature is within mental health treatment in correctional facilities"

7.3 Proposed Structure

What you need:

- Session format (individual/group)
- Length
- Content areas

- Typical number of sessions in correctional settings

YOUR NOTES:

""Research and find typical number of sessions"

7.4 Staff & Facilitator Competence

What you need:

- Training requirements
- Fidelity monitoring
- Supervision

YOUR NOTES:

""A recent survey of state departments of corrections reported that more than half train correctional officers in cognitive behavioral interventions and more than a third train them in the RNR model. However, an average officer receives less than 2.5 hours of training in each of these areas."

7.5 Anticipated Challenges

What you need:

- Institutional barriers
- Client resistance
- Staffing
- Funding

CHAPTER 8: GAPS IN LITERATURE & CONTRIBUTION

8.1 Summary of Key Findings

What you need:

- Synthesize main themes

8.2 Identify Gaps

What you need:

- Lack of developmentally informed programs for 18-26
- No evidence-based desistance programs for EA in corrections

YOUR NOTES:

""There are really no established interventions with evidence of efficacy to reduce recidivism among emerging adults with or without SMHC"

""Lack of developmentally informed, evidence-based desistance programs for 18-26 year old in corrections"

8.3 Theoretical & Practical Contributions

What you need:

- How this program fills empirical/applied gaps

CHAPTER 9: SUMMARY

9.1 Recap Major Themes

9.2 Reaffirm Importance

9.3 Review

QUICK STATS REFERENCE

Recidivism:

- 85% reincarcerated within 5 years (residential treatment)
- 80% of violent juvenile offenders recidivate
- 33% reoffend within 1 year
- 22% (6mo), 34% (12mo), 51% (24mo), 61% (36mo)

Public Support:

- 88% support adult rehab (2001)
- 98% support juvenile rehab (2001)
- 87.2% support rehab (2017)
- 81.4% support rehabilitation ceremonies

Substance Use:

- 78.4% of justice-involved teens test positive for drugs
- 98% have mental condition related to substance use

Trauma:

- Average 3 ACEs prior to first arrest

Cost:

- \$5.7 billion/year juvenile incarceration
- \$139 million/year substance programs

Updated: February 2026 | You are currently writing Section 3

— Sonya ■